Clock Settings Cards

A friendly getting-started guide

Nothing stalls a peaceful evening like a digital chess clock beeping in menu mode. These cards do two things: keep the honest facts of the common time controls at hand, and — the real trick — let you write down *your own clock's steps*, one card per preset, so the next game starts from memory instead of a manual hunt.

How to use it

1. **Two words to know:** *increment* adds time after each move (clock grows back); *delay* waits a few seconds before charging you (clock pauses, never grows). Both are kindnesses to slow writers.
2. **How settings are written:** "G/90 +30" means game in 90 minutes, plus 30 seconds added per move. "G/3 +2" gets fast and sweaty fast.
3. **Grab one card per time control you actually play.** Most club players live on three or four; nobody needs nine cards.
4. **Set it on your clock once, slowly,** writing each button press or menu step on the card. That opus of scribbles is the free manual your clock never came with.
5. **Tick "used it in a game"** with the date. Three ticks on a card is a sign that preset is truly yours.

Pencils only. Clock menus get revised by firmware updates and memory lapses alike — pencil steps can be corrected without ceremony.

Beginner tip: Most clocks remember the *last* preset used. If games start slow because you keep re-inventing the evening, pick one or two presets to be your house defaults and leave the rest of the menu alone.

Six presets, base to bullet

90 + 30 · club classical

On the clock: 90 min each, +30 s per move (increment)

When to use: long club games and opens; one hard think affordable per move

Steps on my clock (my words):

5 + 3 · blitz with manners

On the clock: 5 min each, +3 s per move (increment)

When to use: casual blitz that still rewards planning over slapping

Steps on my clock (my words):

15 + 10 · rapid, room to breathe

On the clock: 15 min each, +10 s per move (increment)

When to use: serious practice with a real position search, low stress

Steps on my clock (my words):

3 + 2 · sharp blitz

On the clock: 3 min each, +2 s per move (increment)

When to use: classic club blitz; instincts get reps, openings get tested

Steps on my clock (my words):

10 + 5 · rapid league

On the clock: 10 min each, +5 s per move (increment)

When to use: league rounds and evening rapid nights; ideas still count

Steps on my clock (my words):

1 + 0 · bullet warm-up

On the clock: 1 min each, no add (flat sprint)

When to use: light warm-up and board-hand speed; never for learning

Steps on my clock (my words):

Pencils only — no pens near the board. Increment vs delay note in the guide; if your clock insists on one mode, write that on every card.

My own presets

My preset #1

Name: _____

Base time: _____ Per move: _____ ☐ increment ☐ delay ☐ none

Steps on my clock (my words):

_____

_____

_____

_____

☐ used it in a game on: _____

My preset #3

Name: _____

Base time: _____ Per move: _____ ☐ increment ☐ delay ☐ none

Steps on my clock (my words):

_____

_____

_____

_____

☐ used it in a game on: _____

My preset #2

Name: _____

Base time: _____ Per move: _____ ☐ increment ☐ delay ☐ none

Steps on my clock (my words):

_____

_____

_____

_____

☐ used it in a game on: _____

My preset #4

Name: _____

Base time: _____ Per move: _____ ☐ increment ☐ delay ☐ none

Steps on my clock (my words):

_____

_____

_____

_____

☐ used it in a game on: _____

Pencils only — no pens near the board. Armageddon (White 5 / Black 4, no add, draw favors Black)? Write it up here as your preset — it earns its card when your club runs it.